

Conflict and Peace

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Class Hours: Fri. 9AM-12PM

Office Hours: Thu. 3:30-5:30PM ([Sign up here](#))

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1 Course Description

Conflicts encompass a broad range of violent events that disrupt the economic and social stability of individuals and states, including crime, political violence, civil wars, and inter-state wars. Peace refers to the absence or resolution of conflict and the institutional and economic progress that helps prevent it. The existence of capable states that can prevent and mitigate conflict is crucial for peace. With the global rise in conflicts, it is essential to understand their origins and explore pathways to peace.

This course covers topics in the political economy of development related to conflict and peace. The course will be organized around four key questions: What causes conflict? What are its consequences for individuals and states? How do individuals respond to conflicts? How can a state develop the capacities that allow it to maintain peace?

Each class will consist of discussions on seminal papers, with two students taking turns presenting two selected papers. Throughout the semester, assignments will build the ability to critically engage with scholarly work, assess its claims, conduct empirical analysis, and develop original research that addresses gaps in the literature.

2 Prerequisites (MA students: Speak to me in person)

- Familiarity with statistical inference: Students will assess empirical research and write a virtual paper demonstrating argumentation based on data.
- (Not required, but helpful) Graduate-level micro/macroeconomics: Frameworks often involve game theory, constrained optimization, and principal-agent problems.

3 Lecture Materials and topics

I will upload slides no later than the day before the lecture. Papers that will be discussed in the class will be presented in the latter half of this syllabus. There are no designated textbooks for

this course. However, the following books are recommended for understanding how economists and political scientists study conflicts and peace

- Daron Acemoglu, James A. Robinson (2012), *Why Nations Fail: The Origins of Power, Prosperity, and Poverty*, Crown Business
- Jean-Marie Baland, François Bourguignon, Jean-Phillipe Platteau, and Thierry Verdier (2020), *Handbook of Economic Development and Institutions*, Princeton University Press
- Timothy Besley, and Torsten Persson (2011), *Pillars of Prosperity: The Political Economics of Development Clusters*, Princeton University Press
- Chris Blattman (2022), *Why We Fight: The Roots of War and the Paths to Peace*, Viking

The four topics covered in this course are as follows:

1. Cause of conflicts: Conflicts occur in many places, especially in developing countries. How do economic incentives drive individuals and states into conflict? How do political and ethnic dynamics lead to conflict? How and why do people engage in criminal activities?
2. Consequences of conflicts: Conflicts may undermine development prospects or trigger shifts that promote long-term progress. How do they affect the economic and non-economic outcomes of individuals? How do they shape economic development? How do they alter the institutional development of the state?
3. Response to conflicts: Individuals respond to conflicts by either fighting back or migrating. How do we overcome the collective action problems required to fight back? What causes people to migrate? What happens to migrants? How do people integrate to the host society after migration?
4. State capacity: An effective state can mobilize fiscal and human resources to prevent conflict and promote development. Why do some states fail at this? How do capable states build and maintain fiscal capacity? How do they manage personnel capacity?

4 Grading Policy

Snap presentation (10%)

Each week, two students will give a 15-minute presentation on two papers from the reading list (marked with double asterisks), with each student presenting one paper. The presenter will be **chosen at random on the day of the class**. Thus, **everyone** must prepare presentation slides for the two papers. Each presentation can use up to 8 slides (excluding title) covering: 1) motivation and research questions, 2) background, 3) data and empirical strategy, 4) key findings, 5) mechanisms, and 6) a critical self-assessment.

This component evaluates students' engagement with class materials and their ability to communicate research clearly. Overly long or off-topic presentations are discouraged.

Replication exercise (20%)

This exercise involves reproducing key findings from an empirical paper and submitting a report. Most empirical papers include data and code to allow others to verify the credibility of their results. Each student is expected to use **R** or **Stata** to replicate one of the following papers and check if the findings are reproduced by writing their own code.

- Brodeur, Abel, (2018), "The Effect of Terrorism on Employment and Consumer Sentiment: Evidence from Successful and Failed Terror Attacks", *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 10(4), 246-282
- Campante, Felipe R, and Quoc-anh Do (2014), "Isolated Capital Cities, Accountability, and Corruption: Evidence from US States", *American Economic Review*, 104(8), 2456-2481

After completing the replication, each student should **submit a report** covering the following:

- Are the data accessible? Some recent papers use administrative data, which are accurate but often restricted. Others construct datasets by merging publicly available sources.
- Do the key findings replicate? Focus on replicating the most important tables or figures that support the paper's core claims. Are your results similar or different? If different, how so? You must also **submit your code (R or Stata)** to demonstrate your independent effort.
- Make your own extensions: Try alternative regression specifications, different choices of independent variables, sample restrictions, or falsification tests. You can use the original dataset or combine it with other sources. If extensions are not feasible due to data limitations, outline a detailed plan for how you would conduct the research differently.

Final Exam (20%)

There will be a cumulative exam focusing on the papers discussed in class, specifically those marked with single or double asterisks in the reading list. The questions will assess your understanding of the theoretical frameworks covered and ask you to connect an empirical finding—either provided in the exam or drawn from the reading list—to a relevant theory.

Virtual Paper (50%)

Your assignment is to develop a viable paper plan that clearly motivates the research question, explains the background, data, and empirical strategy, and includes some preliminary results. The paper does not need to be complete—a **half-finished but original and exciting project is preferred** over a complete yet uninteresting one. The draft counts for 30% of your grade. You'll deliver a 20-minute presentation of your virtual paper in the final class, which counts for 10%.

The paper should be written **in a scholarly article format**. For instance:

1. Introduction: What is your research question? Why is it important from a scholarly or policy standpoint?
2. Literature review: What is the gap in the relevant literature? How are you filling that gap?

3. Background: What is the relevant information on the context that you are studying?
4. Data: What data source are you using or planning to use? Why should it be that dataset?
5. Empirical strategy: What statistical methods do you use? How do they allow for causal inference? What are the potential threats to that inference?
6. Preliminary results: What are the statistical relationships that you have found so far?
7. Mechanism and falsification tests: What factors may explain your main results? What are your plans to address potential factors that may nullify your findings?

You will regularly discuss your virtual paper ideas with me. By October 31st, submit a **2-page research proposal** outlining your question, contribution, background, and potential data sources. There is no need for results or detailed explanations on empirical strategy and falsification tests at this stage. This proposal counts for 10% of your grade.

5 Course Structure and Logistics

Rules regarding collaboration

Collaboration is encouraged assuming that (1) each student writes their own assignments, and (2) students must clearly identify their collaborators.

Rules regarding AI usage

AI tools may be used for assistive purposes only—such as proofreading, grammar checking, and coding support. However, using AI to generate complete assignments - presentations and take-home exams, in particular - is strictly prohibited. All submitted work, **especially the virtual paper**, must be original writing and analysis. One way to show that you are writing a paper with your own idea is to discuss your ideas with me throughout the office hours openly (without aid of AI). Any use of AI must be properly disclosed to the instructor. Violations will be treated as academic dishonesty and subject to disciplinary action under university policies.

6 Schedule and reading list

The schedule is tentative and may change. Students are expected to prepare presentations on papers marked with double asterisks. Papers with a single asterisk will be discussed in class.

Important deadlines

- Presentation on research proposal: October 31st (Submit 2-page draft by email before class)
- Replication exercise due date: November 21st, midnight (Submit codes and report by email)
- Presentation on the virtual paper: December 12th, in class
- Virtual Paper due date: December 23rd, midnight (Submit the draft by email)
- Final Exam: Week of December 19th, (exact time TBA)

6.1 Course Introduction and empirical analysis: Week 1

I will go over course organization, how to do assignments, and introduce the topics covered in this class. We will also discuss empirical frameworks necessary to understand the papers covered in this class. There will also be demonstration using Stata and R

- Conceptualizing Treatment Effects
- Ordinary least squares and randomized control trials
- Panel regression
- Instrumental variable methods
- Difference-in-differences, event studies, and regression discontinuity

6.2 What causes conflicts: Week 2-4

Economic incentives behind conflicts

- ** Berman, Eli, Michael Callen, Joseph H. Felter, and Jacob N. Shapiro, (2011), "Do Working Men Rebel? Insurgency and Unemployment in Afghanistan, Iraq, and the Philippines", *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, 55(4), 496-528
- Berman, Nicolas, Mathieu Couttenier, Dominic Rohner, and Matias Thoenig, (2017), "This Mine is Mine! How Minerals Fuel Conflicts in Africa", *American Economic Review*, 107(6), 1564-1610
- * Blattman, Christopher, and Jeannie Annan, (2016), "Can Employment Reduce Lawlessness and Rebellion? A Field Experiment with High-Risk Men in a Fragile State", *American Political Science Review*, 110(1), 1-17
- ** Cao, Yiming, and Shuo Chen, (2022), "Rebel on the Canal: Disrupted Trade Access and Social Conflict in China, 1650-1911", *American Economic Review*, 112(5), 1555-1590
- * Caselli, Francesco, Massimo Morelli, and Dominic Rohner, (2015), "The Geography of Interstate Resource Wars", *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 130(1), 267-316
- Crost, Benjamin, Joseph Felter, and Patrick Johnston, (2014), "Aid Under Fire: Development Projects and Civil Conflict", *American Economic Review*, 104(6), 1833-1856
- * Dube, Oeindrila, and Juan F. Vargas, (2013), "Commodity Price Shocks and Civil Conflict: Evidence from Colombia", *The Review of Economic Studies*, 80(4), 1384-1421
- * McGuirk, Eoin, and Marshall Burke, (2020), "The Economic Origins of Conflict in Africa", *Journal of Political Economy*, 128(10), 3940-3997
- McGuirk, Eoin, and Nathan Nunn, (2020), "Nomadic Pastoralism, Climate Change, and Conflict in Africa", NBER Working Paper W28243
- * Shapiro, Jacob N., and Oliver Vanden Eynde, (2023), "Fiscal Incentives for Conflict: Evidence from India's Red Corridor", *Review of Economics and Statistics*, 105(1), 217-225

- Vanden Eynde, Oliver, (2016), "Targets of Violence: Evidence from India's Naxalite Conflict", *The Economic Journal*, 128, 887-916

Political and ethnic origins of conflicts

- Bazzi, Samuel, and Matthew Gudgeon, (2021), "The Political Boundaries of Ethnic Divisions", *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 13(1), 235-266
- ** Bonnier, Evelina, Jonas Poulsen, Thorsten Rogall, and Miri Stryjan, (2020), "Preparing for genocide: Quasi-experimental Evidence from Rwanda", *Journal of Development Economics*, 147, 102533
- * Bonomi, Giampaolo, Nicola Gennaioli, and Guido Tabellini, (2021), "Identity, Beliefs, and Political Conflict", *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 136(4), 2371-2411
- * Condra, Luke N., James D. Long, Andrew C Shaver, and Austin L. Wright (2018), "The Logic of Insurgent Electoral Violence", *American Economic Review*, 108(11), 3199-3231
- ** Dube, Oeindrila, and Suresh Naidu, (2015), "Bases, Bullets, and Ballots: The Effect of US Military Aid on Political Conflict in Colombia", *The Journal of Politics*, 77(1), 249-267
- Durante, Ruben, and Ekaterina Zhuravskaya, (2018), "Attacking When the World Is Not Watching? US News and the Israeli-Palestinian Conflict", *Journal of Political Economy*, 126(3), 1085-1133
- * Esteban, Joan, Laura Mayoral, and Debraj Ray, (2012), "Ethnicity and Conflict: An Empirical Study", *American Economic Review*, 102(4), 1310-1342
- * Michalopoulos, Stelios, and Elias Papaioannou, (2016), "The Long-Run Effects of the Scramble for Africa", *American Economic Review*, 106(7), 1802-1848
- Montalvo, José G., and Marta Reynal-Querol, (2005), "Ethnic Polarization, Potential Conflict and Civil Wars", *American Economic Review*, 95(3), 796-816
- Shayo, Moses, (2009), "A Model of Social Identity with an Application to Political Economy: Nation, Class, and Redistribution", *American Political Science Review*, 103(2), 147-174
- Weidmann, Nils B., (2011), "Violence "From Above" or "From Below"? The Role of Ethnicity in Bosnia's Civil War", *The Journal of Politics*, 73(4), 1178-1190
- * Yanagizawa-Drott, David. (2014), "Propaganda and Conflict: Evidence from the Rwandan Genocide", *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 129(4), 1947-1994

Engaging in (organized) crime

- * Blattman, Christopher, Gustavo Duncan, Benjamin Lessing, and Santiago Tobón, (Forthcoming), "Gang Rule: Understanding and Countering Criminal Governance", *Review of Economic Studies*

- Carvalho, Leandro S., and Rodrigo R. Soares, (2016), "Living on the edge: Youth Entry, Career and Exit in Drug-selling Gangs", *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, 121, 77-98
- * Chimeli, Ariaster B., and Rodrigo R. Soares, (2017), "The Use of Violence in Illegal Markets: Evidence from Mahogany Trade in Brazilian Amazon", *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 9(4), 30-57
- * Dell, Melissa, (2015), "Trafficking Networks and the Mexican Drug War", *American Economics Review*, 105(6), 1738-1779
- ** Dix-Carneiro, Rafael, Rodrigo R. Soares, and Gabriel Ulyssea, (2018), "Economic Shocks and Crime: Evidence from Brazilian Trade Liberalization", *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 10(4), 158-195
- Lessing, Benjamin (2020), "Conceptualizing Criminal Governance", *Perspectives on Politics*, 19(3), 854-873
- Magaloni, Beatriz, Gustavo Robles, Aila M. Matanock, Alberto Diaz-Cayeros, and Vidal Romero (2020), "Living in Fear: The Dynamics of Extortion in Mexico's Drug War", *Comparative Political Studies*, 53(7), 1124-1174
- * Pinotti, Paolo (2015), "The Causes and Consequences of Organised Crime: Preliminary Evidence Across Countries", *The Economic Journal*, 125(586), F158-F174
- Pinotti, Paolo (2017), "Clicking on Heaven's Door: The Effect of Immigrant Legalization on Crime", *American Economic Review*, 107(1), 138-168
- ** Trejo, Guillermo, and Sandra Ley (2018), "Why Did Drug Cartels Go to War in Mexico? Subnational Party Alternation, the Breakdown of Criminal Protection, and the Onset of Large-Scale Violence", *Comparative Political Studies*, 51(7), 900-937
- Trejo, Guillermo, and Sandra Ley (2021), "High-Profile Criminal Violence: Why Drug Cartels Murder Government Officials and Party Candidates in Mexico", *British Journal of Political Science*, 51, 203-229

6.3 Consequences of conflicts: Week 5-7 (No class on Week 6, Double Tenth Day)

Impact on individuals

- * Blair, Graeme, Darin Christensen, and Valerie Wirtschafter, (2022) "How Does Armed Conflict Shape Investment? Evidence from the Mining Sector", *The Journal of Politics*, 84(1), 116-133
- Blattman, Christopher, Julian Jamison, M. Margaret Sheridan, (2017), "Reducing Crime and Violence: Experimental Evidence from Cognitive Behavioral Therapy in Liberia", *American Economic Review*, 107(4), 1165-1206
- * Brown, Ryan, and Verónica Montalva, Duncan Thomas, and Adrea Velásquez (2019), "Impact of Violent Crime on Risk Aversion: Evidence From the Mexican Drug War", *Review of Economics and Statistics*, 101(5), 892-904

- Bundervoet, Tom, Philip Verwimp, and Richard Akresh, (2009), "Health and Civil War in Rural Burundi", *Journal of Human Resources*, 44(2), 536-5663
- ** Couttenier, Mathieu, Veronica Petrencu, Dominic Rohner, and Mathias Thoenig, (2019), "The Violent Legacy of Conflict: Evidence on Asylum Seekers, Crime, and Public Policy in Switzerland", *American Economic Review*, 109(12), 4378-4425
- Hjort, Jonas, (2014), "Ethnic Divisions and Production in Firms", *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 129(4), 1899-1946
- * Humphreys, Macartan, and Jeremy M Weinstein, (2007), "Demobilization and Reintegration", *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, 51(4), 531-567
- ** Mirenda, Litterio, Sauro Mocetti, and Lucia Rizzica, (2022), "The Economic Effects of Mafia: Firm Level Evidence", *American Economic Review*, 112(8), 2748-2773
- Monteiro, Joana, and Rudi Rocha, (2017), "Drug Battles and School Achievement", *The Review of Economics and Statistics*, 99(2), 213-228
- * Sviatchi, Maria Micaela, (2022), "Making a Narco: Childhood Exposure to Illegal Labor Markets and Criminal Life Paths", *Econometrica*, 90(4), 1835-1878
- Vincente, Pedro C., and Inês Vilela, (2022). "Preventing Islamic Radicalization: Experimental Evidence on Anti-Social Behavior", *Journal of Comparative Economics*, 50, 474-485

Impact on economic and institutional development

- Acemoglu, Daron, James A. Robinson, and Rafael J. Santos, (2013), "The Monopoly of Violence: Evidence from Colombia", *Journal of European Economic Association*, 11(S1), 5-44
- * Alesina, Alberto, Salvatore Piccolo, and Paolo Pinotti, (2019). "Organized Crime, Violence, and Politics", *Review of Economic Studies*, 86(2), 457-499
- Amodio, Francesco, Giorgio Chiovelli, and Sebastian Hohmann, (2024), "The Employment Effects of Ethnic Politics", *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 16(2), 456-491
- Angelucci, Charles, Simone Meraglia, and Nico Voigtländer, (2022), "How Merchant Towns Shaped Parliaments: From the Norman Conquest of England to the Great Reform Act", *American Economic Review*, 112(10), 3441-3487
- ** Berrebi, Claude, and Esteban F. Klor, (2008), "Are Voters Sensitive to Terrorism? Direct Evidence from Israeli Electorate", *American Political Science Review*, 102(3), 279-301
- * Blouin, Arthur, and Sharun W. Mukand, (2019), "Erasing Ethnicity? Propaganda, Nation Building, and Identity in Rwanda", *Journal of Political Economy*, 127(3), 1008-1062
- * Brückner, Markus, and Antonio Ciccone, (2011), "Rain and the Democratic Window of Opportunity", *Econometrica*, 79(3), 923-947
- Burgess, Robin, Remi Jedwab, Edward Miguel, Ameet Morjaria, and Gerard Padró i Miquel, (2015), "The Value of Democracy: Evidence from Road Building in Kenya", *American Economic Review*, 105(6), 1817-1851

- Daniele, Gianmarco, and Gemme Dipoppa, (2017) "Mafia, Elections, and Violence Against Politicians", *Journal of Public Economics*, 154, 10-33
- * Fenizia, Alessandra, and Raffaele Saggio, (2024), "Organized Crime and Economic Growth: Evidence from Municipalities Infiltrated by the Mafia", *American Economic Review*, 114(7), 2171-2200
- Jones, Benjamin F., and Benjamin A. Olken, (2009), "Hit or Miss? The Effect of Assassinations on Institutions and War", *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics*, 1(2), 55-87
- ** Korovkin, Vasily, and Alexey Makarin, (2023), "Conflict and Intergroup Trade: Evidence from the 2014 Russia-Ukraine Crisis", *American Economic Review*, 113(1), 34-70
- * Pinotti, Paolo, (2015), "The Economic Costs of Organised Crime: Evidence from Southern Italy", *The Economic Journal*, 125, F203-F232

6.4 Presentation on a 2-page proposal: Week 9

Students will deliver a 20-minute presentation on their proposal

6.5 Individual responses to conflicts: Week 10-11

Resistance: Overcoming collective action problems

- ** Bursztyin, Leonardo, Davide Cantoni, David Y. Yang, Noam Yuchtman, and Y. Jane Zhang, (2021), "Persistent Political Engagement: Social Interactions and the Dynamics of Protest Movements", *American Economic Review: Insights*, 3(2), 233-250
- Campante, Felipe R., and Davin Chor, (2012), "Why was the Arab World Poised for Revolution? Schooling, Economic Opportunities and Arab Spring", *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 26(2), 167-188
- * Dippel, Christian, and Stephan Heblich, (2021), "Leadership in Social Movements: Evidence from the "Forty-Eighters" in Civil War", *American Economic Review*, 111(2), 472-505
- * Enikolopov, Ruben, Alexey Makarin, and Maria Petrova, (2020), "Social Media and Protest Participation: Evidence from Russia", *Econometrica*, 88(4), 1479-1514
- ** Gagliarducci, Stefano, Massimiliano Gaetano Onorato, Francesco Sobbrino, and Guido Tabellini, (2020), "War of the Waves: Radio and Resistance during World War II", *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 12(4), 1-38
- * Guriev, Sergei, Nikita Melnikov, and Ekaterina Zhuravskaya, (2021), "3G Internet and Confidence in Government", *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 136(4), 2533-2613
- Madestam, Andreas, Daniel Shoag, Stan Veuger, and David Yanagizawa-Drott, (2013), "Do Political Protests Matter? Evidence from the Tea Party Movement", *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 128(4), 1633-1683
- * Manacorda, Marco, and Andrea Tesei, (2020) "Liberation Technology: Mobile Phones and Political Mobilization in Africa", *Econometrica*, 88(2), 533-567

- Mazumder, Soumyajit, (2018), "The Persistent Effect of U.S. Civil Rights Protests on Political Attitudes", *American Journal of Political Science*, 62(4), 922-935
- Morris, Kevin T., and Kelsey Shoub (2024), "Contested Killings: The Mobilizing Effects of Community Contact with Police Violence", *American Political Science Review*, 118(1), 458-474
- * Ostrom, Elinor, (2000), "Collective Action and the Evolution of Social Norms", *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 14(3), 137-158
- Tezcür, Günes Murat, (2016), "Ordinary People, Extraordinary Risks: Participation in an Ethnic Rebellion", *American Political Science Review*, 110(2), 247-264

Consequences of migration and host society perceptions

- * Alesina, Alberto, Armando Miano, and Stefanie Stantcheva, (2023), "Immigration and Redistribution", *Review of Economic Studies*, 90(1), 1-38
- Alesina, Alberto, Marco Tabellini, (2024), "The Political Effects of Immigration: Culture or Economics?", *Journal of Economic Literature*, 62(1), 5-46
- ** Becker, Sascha O., Irena Grosfeld, Pauline Grosjean, Nico Voigtländer, and Ekaterina Zhuravskaya, (2020), "Forced Migration and Human Capital: Evidence from Post-WWII Population Transfers", *American Economic Review*, 110(5), 1430-1463
- * Card, David, (1990), "The Impact of Mariel Boatlift on the Miami Labor Market", *Industrial and Labor Relations Review*, 43(2), 245-257
- Edin, Per-Anders, Peter Fredriksson, and Olof Åslund, (2003), "Ethnic Enclaves and the Economic Success of Immigrants-Evidence from A Natural Experiment", *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 118(1), 329-357
- * Fouka, Vassily, and Marco Tabellini. (2022). "Changing In-Group Boundaries: The Effect of Immigration on Race Relations in the United States", *American Political Science Review*, 116(3), 968-984
- ** Hainmueller, Jens, Michael J. Hiscox, (2010), "Attitudes toward Highly Skilled and Low-skilled Immigration: Evidence from a Survey Experiment", *American Political Science Review*, 104(1), 61-84
- Ibáñez, Ana María, Andrés Moya, María Adelaida Ortega, Sandra V. Roza, and Maria José Urbina (Forthcoming), "Life Out of the Shadows: The Impacts of Regularization Programs on the Lives of Forced Immigrants", *Journal of European Economic Association*
- Imbermann, Scott A., Adriana D. Kugler, Bruce I. Sacerdote, (2012), "Katrina's Children: Evidence on the Structure of Peer Effects from Hurricane Evacuees", 102(5), 2048-2082
- * Mahajan, Parag, and Dean Yang, (2020), "Taken by Storm: Hurricanes, Migrant Networks, and US Immigration", *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 12(2), 250-277
- Schon, Justin, (2019), "Motivation and Opportunity for Conflict-induced Migration: An Analysis of Syrian Migration Timing", *Journal of Peace Research*, 56(1), 12-27

- * Waldinger, Fabian, (2010), "Quality Matters: The Expulsion of Professors and the Consequences for PhD Student Outcomes in Nazi Germany", *Journal of Political Economy*, 118(4), 787-831

6.6 State Capacity: Week 12-14

Theoretical frameworks and weak states

- Acemoglu, Daron, Suresh Naidu, Pascual Restrepo, and James A. Robinson, (2019), "Democracy Does Cause Growth", *Journal of Political Economy*, 127(1), 47-100
- * Besley, Timothy, (2020), "State Capacity, Reciprocity, and Social Contract", *Econometrica*, 88(4), 1307-1335
- * Besley, Timothy, and Torsten Persson, (2009), "The Origins of State Capacity: Property Rights, Taxation, and Politics", *American Economic Review*, 99(4), 1218-1244
- Blattman, Christopher, Alexandra C. Hartman, and Robert A. Blair, (2014), "How to Promote Order and Property Rights under Weak Rule of Law? An Experiment in Changing Dispute Resolution Behavior through Community Education", *American Political Science Review*, 108(1), 100-120
- * Dal Bó, Ernesto, Pedro Dal Bó, and Rafael Di Tella, (2006), "Plata o Plomo? Bribe and Punishment in a Theory of Political Influence", *American Political Science Review*, 100(1), 41-53
- Dincecco, Mark, and Gabriel Katz, (2014), "State Capacity and Long-Run Economic Performance", *The Economic Journal*, 126, 189-218
- * Gennaioli, Nicola, and Hans-Joachim Voth, (2015), "State Capacity and Military Conflict", *The Review of Economic Studies*, 82, 1409-1448
- Harstad, Bård, and Jakob Svensson, (2011), "Bribes, Lobbying, and Development", *American Political Science Review*, 105(1), 46-63
- Michalopoulos, Stelios, and Elias Papaioannou, (2013), "Pre-Colonial Ethnic Institutions and Contemporary African Development", *Econometrica*, 81(1), 113-152
- ** Rogowski, Jon. C., John Gerring, Matthew Maguire, and Lee Cojocaru, (2022), "Public Infrastructure and Economic Development: Evidence from Postal Systems", *American Journal of Political Science*, 66(4), 885-901
- ** Sanchez de la Sierra, Ruben, (2020), "On the Origins of the State: Stationary Bandits and Taxation in Eastern Congo", *Journal of Political Economy*, 128(1), 32-74
- * Shleifer, Andrei, and Robert W. Vishny, (1993), "Corruption", *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 108(3), 599-617

Fiscal capacity

- * Balán, Pablo, Augustin Bergeron, Gabriel Tourek, and Jonathan L. Weigel, (2022), "Local Elites as State Capacity: How City Chiefs Use Local Information to Increase Tax Compliance in the Democratic Republic of Congo", *American Economic Review*, 112(3), 762-797
- Benhassine, Najy, David McKenzie, Victor Pouliquen, and Massimiliano Santini, (2018), "Does Inducing Informal Firms to Formalize Make Sense? Experimental Evidence from Benin", *Journal of Public Economics*, 157, 1-14
- Besley, Timothy and Torsten Persson, (2010), "State Capacity, Conflict and Development", *Econometrica*, 78(1), 1-34
- ** Ch, Rafael, Jacob Shapiro, Abbey Steel, and Juan F. Vargas, (2018), "Endogenous Taxation in Ongoing Internal Conflict: The Case of Colombia", *American Political Science Review*, 112(4), 996-1015
- Christensen, Darin, and Francisco Garfias, (2021), "The Politics of Property Taxation: Fiscal Infrastructure and Electoral Incentives in Brazil", *The Journal of Politics*, 83(4), 1399-1416
- * Gordon, Roger, and Wei Li, (2009), "Tax Structures in Developing Countries: Many Puzzles and a Possible Explanation", *Journal of Public Economics*, 93, 855-866
- * Henn, Soeren J., Christian Mastaki Mugaruka, Miguel Ortiz, Raúl Sánchez de la Sierra, David Qihang Wu (2025), "Monopoly of Taxation Without a Monopoly of Violence: The Weak State's Trade-Offs From Taxation", *Review of Economic Studies*, 92(2), 1126-1156
- * Jensen, Anders (2022), "Employment Structure and the Rise of the Modern Tax System", *American Economic Review*, 112(1), 213-234
- * Okunogbe, Oyebola, and Gabriel Tourek, (2024), "How Can Lower-Income Countries Collect More Taxes? The Role of Technology, Tax Agents and Politics", *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 38(1), 81-106
- ** Olsson, Ola, Maria Eriksson Baaz, and Peter Martinsson, (2020), "Fiscal Capacity in "Post"-Conflict States: Evidence from Trade on Congo River", *Journal of Development Economics*, 146, 102506
- Pomeranz, Dina, (2015), "No Taxation without Information: Deterrence and Self-Enforcement in the Value Added Tax", *American Economic Review*, 105(8), 2539-2569
- Weigel, Jonathan L., (2020), "The Participation Dividend of Taxation: How Citizens in Congo Engage More with the State when It Tries to Tax Them", *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 135(4), 1849-1903

Personnel capacity

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6.7 Presentation on virtual paper: Week 15

Prepare a 20-minute presentation (including questions asked during the presentation)

6.8 Final exam: Timed take-home exam at mid-December (after presentations)

Specific logistics will be decided and announced by mid-November. Papers marked with single or double asterisks will be covered in the exam.